

AI Citation & Disclosure Quick Guide

Student handout. Verified against MLA and APA guidance as of July 2026 — style guidance evolves, so check current sources.

Cite what you quote. Disclose what helped. Verify what AI mentions. Own what you submit.

1. Citation

When a specific AI response is itself your source — you're quoting or analyzing what the AI produced.

Include: what you asked for, the tool and model, the date, and a share link if one exists. Neither MLA nor APA treats AI as an author — it's a tool whose output you're citing.

Pattern (adapt to your teacher's required style):

"[Description of what was generated]" prompt. [Tool name, model/version], [company], [date]. [link if available]

2. Disclosure

Explaining how AI assisted work that is still yours. Most student AI use needs disclosure, not citation.

Fill-in template:

I used _____ to help me with _____.

The kind of prompt I entered: _____.

I checked the response by _____.

I changed, corrected, or added _____.

The final decisions and submitted work are my responsibility.

3. Source citation

Crediting the actual books, articles, and websites behind the ideas. An AI's summary of a source is not the source. If AI mentions a study: confirm it exists, find it, read the relevant part, and cite it — not the AI.

4. Authorship

Whose name is on it. Whatever tools helped, the person who submits the work is accountable for its accuracy and honesty. "The AI said so" carries the same weight as "some guy online said so."

Before you submit

- ☐ Did I check it?
- ☐ Did I disclose it?
- ☐ Can I explain it?

Yes to all three, or it's not ready.